

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

84%

Developers Currently Working

Full-time, part-time, or freelance

ies

42%

Work in Hybrid Arrangements

Most common work mode in 2024

22,677

Salary Responses Analyzed

34.7% response rate

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

69%

Global Full-Time

Dominant employment mode

64.8%

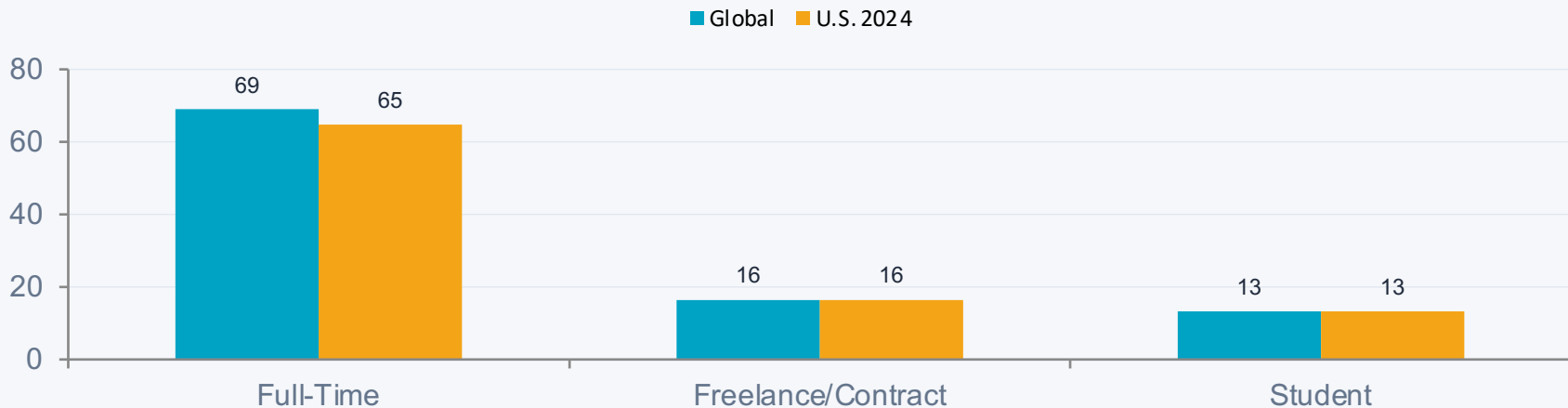
U.S. Full-Time 2024

Down from 69% in 2023 (-4.2pp)

16.4%

Freelance / Contract

Global independent contractors



In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

42%

Hybrid

Unchanged from 2023

38%

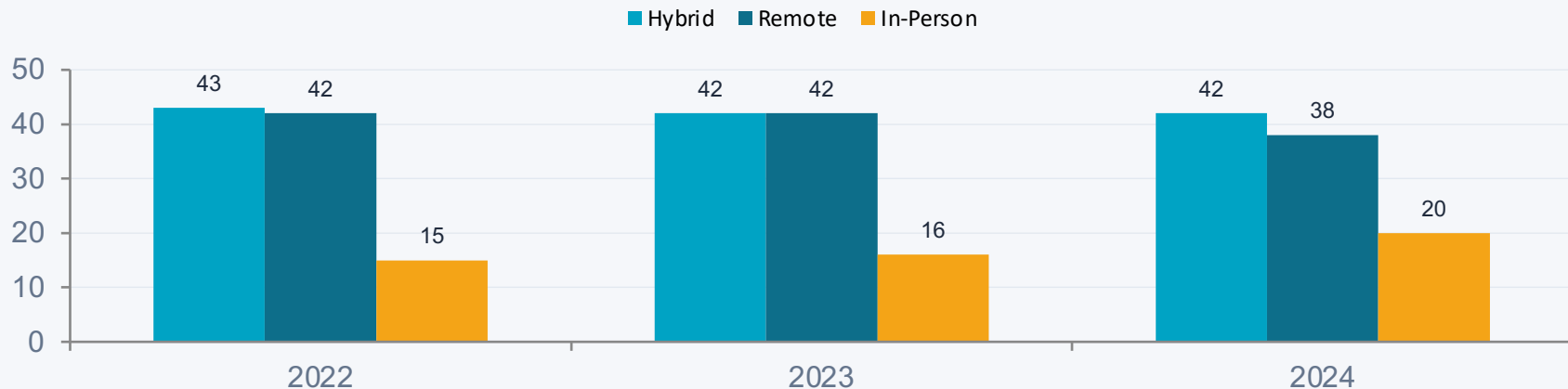
Remote

Fully distributed

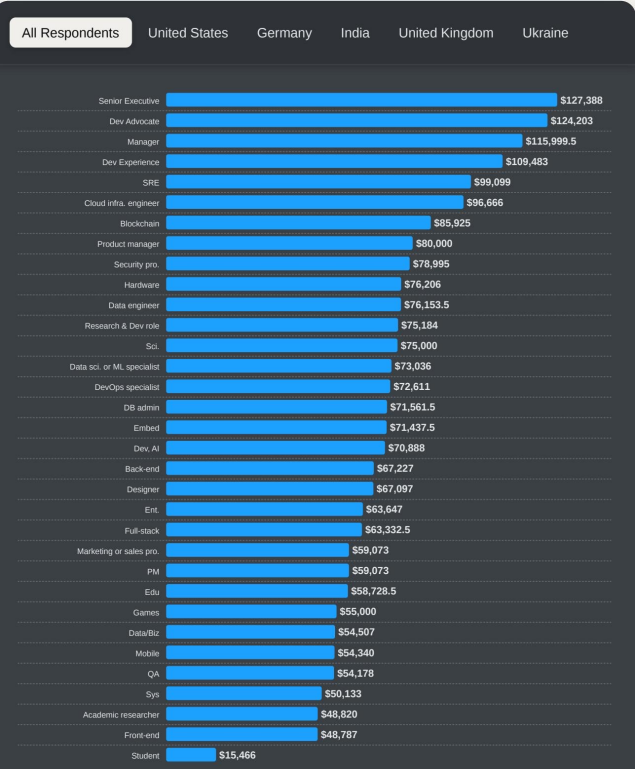
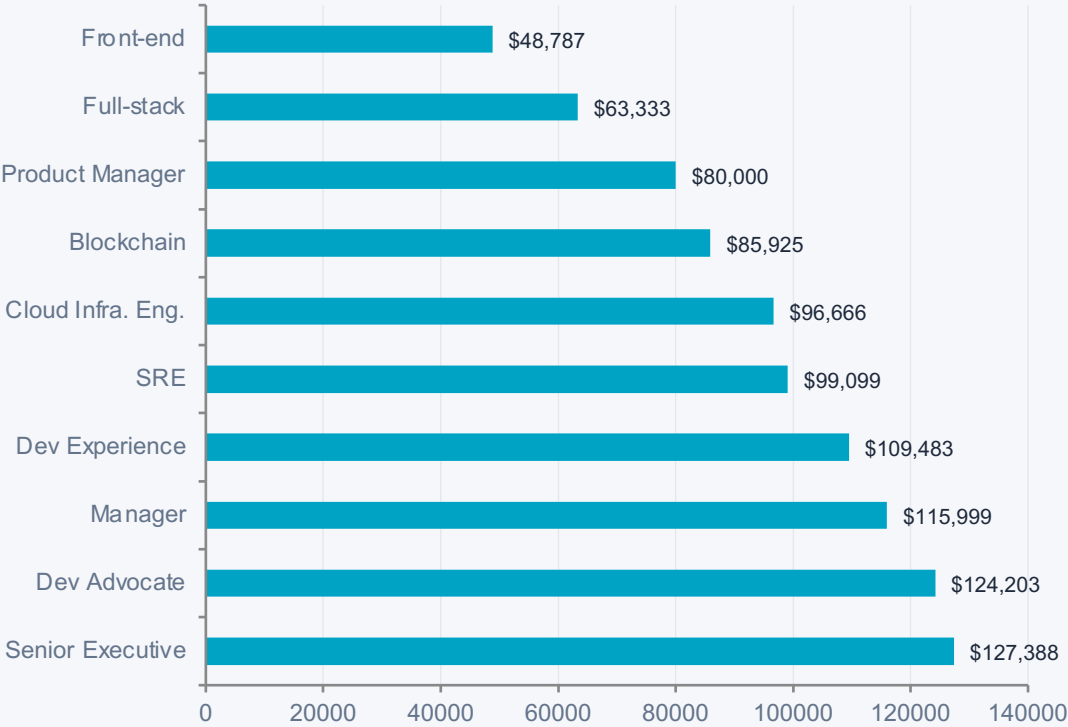
20%

In-Person

Up from 15% in 2022



Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

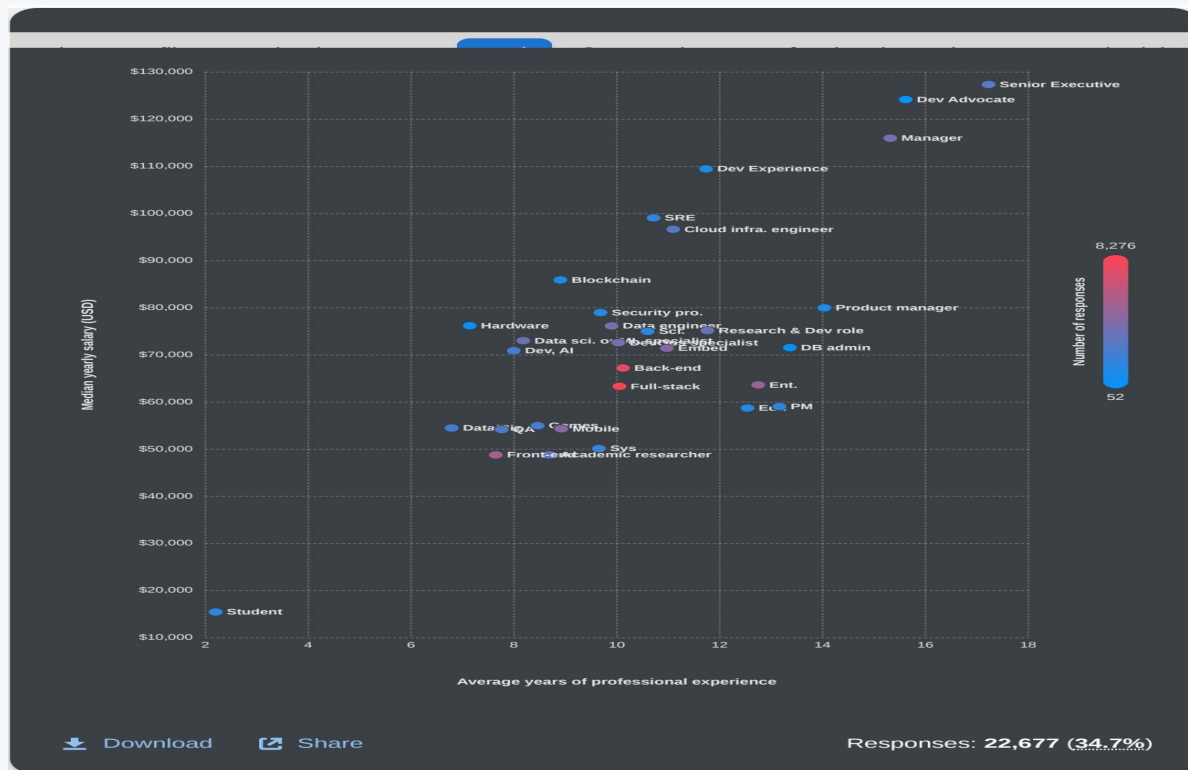


Reference chart: Stack Overflow Survey 2024 — Salary by developer type

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Senior Exec / Dev Advocate
\$124K–\$127K · ~16–17 yrs

Student outlier
\$15K · ~2 yrs experience



Reference chart: Stack Overflow Survey 2024 — Salary vs. experience by developer type

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Top Earners (Functional)

Erlang ~\$97K · 12 yrs

Clojure ~\$95K · 11 yrs

Elixir ~\$93K · 11 yrs

Lowest Earners

Prolog ~\$43K · 9 yrs

Dart ~\$44K · 8 yrs

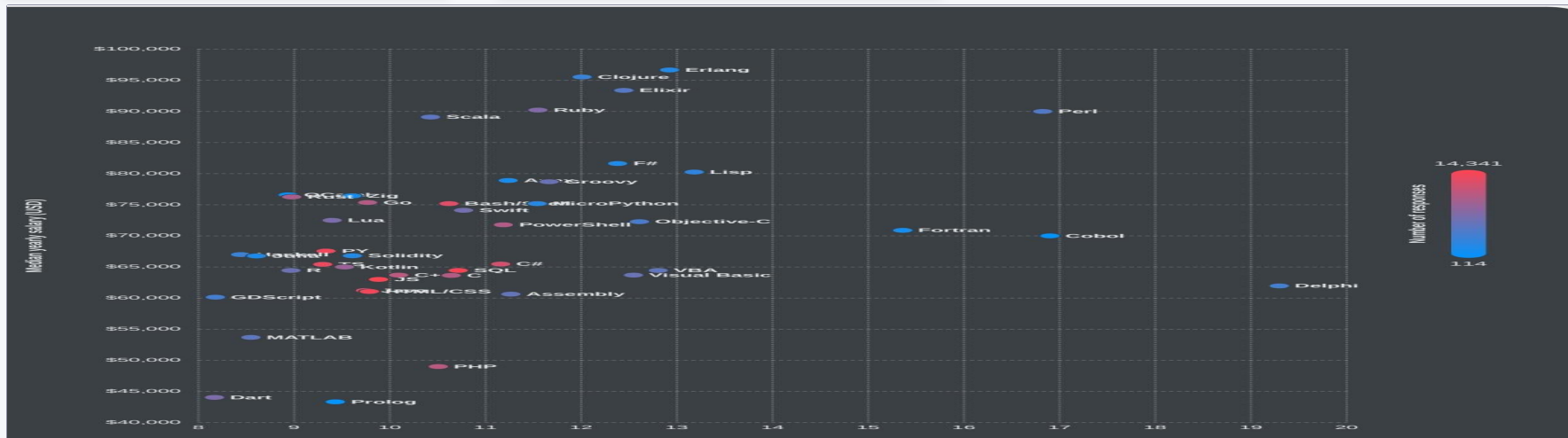
PHP ~\$49K · 10 yrs

⚠ YoY Salary Drop

Overall range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023:

2024: \$60–75K avg

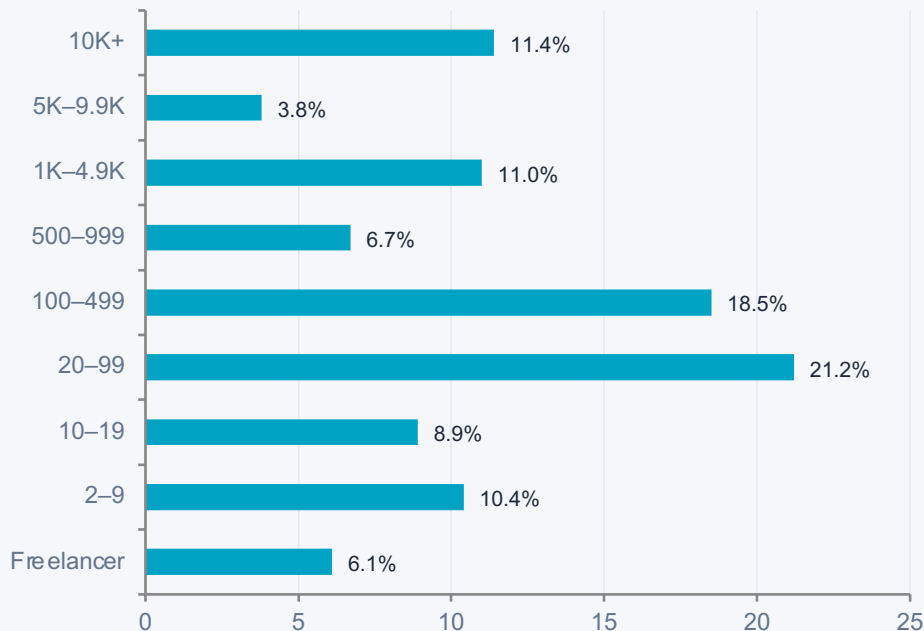
2023: \$70–85K avg



Stack Overflow Survey 2024 — Median salary vs. experience by programming language

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company Size Distribution (42,827 respondents)



62%

influence tech purchases

across all respondents

60%

prefer build-and-buy

vs. pure build or buy

75%

use free trials

to evaluate new tools

73%

ask other developers

for tool recommendations

Top influencers: Senior Exec (99%) · Eng. Manager (87%) · Product Manager (77%)

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

01

Plan for More Contractors

U.S. full-time employment fell 4pp YoY to 64.8%. Freelancing holds at 16%+. Budget and legal frameworks for a blended workforce.

02

Hybrid Is the New Default — But In-Person Is Creeping Back

Hybrid (42%) still dominates, but in-person rose from 15% (2022) to 20% (2024). RTO mandates need evidence-based justification.

03

Premium Roles: DevRel & SRE Command Serious Pay

Senior Execs (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), Managers (\$116K), and SREs (\$99K) all demand above-market compensation.

04

Niche Languages = Premium Salaries

Erlang (\$97K), Clojure (\$95K), Elixir (\$93K) developers earn far more than JavaScript (\$64K) or PHP (\$49K) counterparts.

05

Engage Developers in Purchase Decisions

62% of devs influence tech buys; 75% use free trials to evaluate tools. Vendor strategies must target ICs, not just leadership.